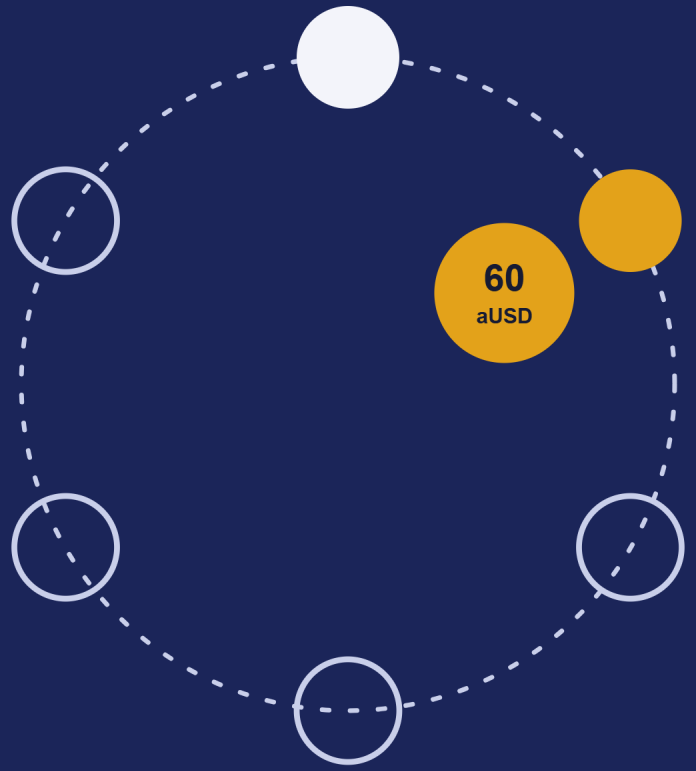
Portaldot Hacker House 2026, Ecosystem DApps track

AjoChain

Save in a circle.
The contract holds the pot.



Rotating savings circles (ajo, esusu, adashe) enforced by smart contracts on Portaldot Network V3

Chisom Caleb Ogueji, Lagos

Saving is hard, and ajo is still how millions do it

61%

of Nigerian adults are in severe liquidity distress, even as access to finance grows.

64.4%

of adults now use digital financial services, up from 45% in 2023.

Ajo, esusu and adashe still move billions of naira every week, but collector fraud is pushing savers toward digital tools. AjoChain keeps the circle and removes the collector.

Sources: EFInA Access to Financial Services in Nigeria (A2F) 2026 survey, Sept 2026; Leadership, Oct 2026; NewsTimes, May 2026

One tradition, every continent

Rotating savings circles have been around for generations, built on trust between members and on a collector who holds the money.

17%

Nigeria · Ajo, esusu

of adults save in an informal savings group

41%

Kenya · Chama

of Kenyans use chamas: about 300,000 groups holding roughly KSh 300bn

1 in 5

Ghana · Susu

adults use structured informal savings or borrowing groups

1 in 5

Mexico · Tanda

savers use tandas, the country's second most popular informal method

Also **susu** and **partner** across the Caribbean, and **hui** in China.

> **The weak point is the same everywhere: 13% of Kenyan chama members have lost money in their group. AjoChain keeps the circle and replaces the collector with a smart contract.**

Sources: NBS Nigeria / World Bank LSMS brief; FSD Kenya FinAccess 2019 and The Standard; Global Findex 2017 via OPM Savings at the Frontier (2022); INEGI/CNBV ENIF 2024 via Milenio

But the circle runs on trust

The collector disappears

One person holds everyone's money between rounds. If they vanish, so do the savings.

Early receivers stop paying

A member who already took the pot has little reason to keep paying, and the last members lose out.

Good savers leave no trace

Years of paying on time never become a record a lender or another group can see.

AjoChain puts the pot in a smart contract.

Same circle, same rules. Nobody holds the money, missed payments are covered automatically, and every clean cycle becomes a savings record the member owns.

How a circle runs

1

Create

Set the contribution, the number of members and the round length.

2

Join

Lock one contribution as collateral. The circle starts when the last seat fills.

3

Pay

When the last member pays, the full pot goes straight to that round's member.

4

Close late rounds

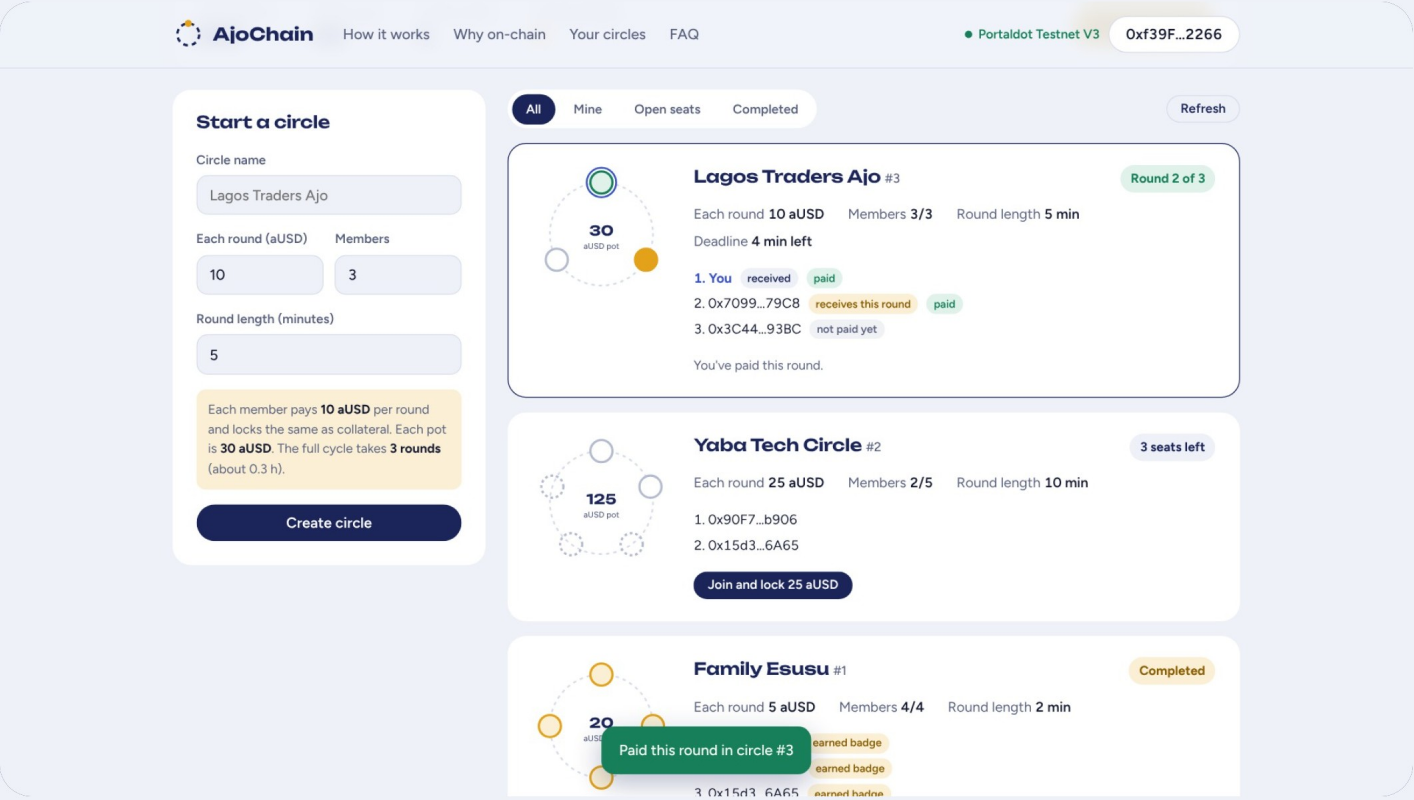
After the deadline anyone can close the round. Collateral fills the gap.

5

Earn a badge

A clean cycle returns your collateral and mints a soulbound AjoBadge.

A working dApp



See the whole circle

Who has paid, who receives this round, and time left.

One click per action

Join, pay and close rounds from MetaMask.

Ready to try

A built-in faucet gives 1,000 test aUSD.

Live demo: ajochain-five.vercel.app

Collateral keeps the pot full

Example: three members, 10 aUSD per round, 10 aUSD collateral each.

Round	What happens	Pot	Goes to
1	Everyone pays	30 aUSD	Ada
2	Emeka misses the deadline. Anyone closes the round and his collateral covers it.	30 aUSD, still full	Tunde
3	Everyone pays	30 aUSD	Emeka

At the end Ada and Tunde get their collateral back and an AjoBadge. Emeka's collateral is spent and he earns no badge for this circle.

Why Portaldot

EVM compatibility, today

Standard Solidity with ERC-20 and ERC-721 runs on V3 unchanged, so MetaMask and existing tooling work out of the box.

WASM beside EVM, next

The savings-reputation registry can move to an ink! contract that any EVM app reads, using V3's dual runtime.

Multi-chain savings

Cross-chain support lets circles save in stablecoins that live on other networks.

An ecosystem to launch with

Mainnet migration, technical review and community programs for teams that keep building.

Built during the Hacker House

3
Solidity contracts

8/8
tests passing

1
live web dApp

Contract (Portaldot testnet)	Address
AjoManager: circles, payouts, defaults	0xD9f1Fb1D6f634696763A345890F32C50603B653A
AjoBadge: soulbound ERC-721	0x9a4720B2B3D607EE9c382Ec1369cb748236E535c
MockUSDT (aUSD): ERC-20 test stablecoin	0x3Ce64f4776E26c4A930d1fdfCeD1acfBec5cC551

Code and transaction hashes: github.com/blockchaincali/ajochain

How AjoChain earns

Payout fee

A small cut of each pot, [0.5%], taken at payout. Members never pay to join.

Organiser tools

Paid features for cooperatives, market associations and employers running many circles.

Credit signal

With a member's consent, lenders read their AjoBadge history to price small loans.

First users: traders and small merchants who already run ajo, reached through ShopSwift's merchant network.

Roadmap

Now

- Contracts and tests
- Portaldot testnet deploy
- Web dApp with faucet

Next

- Audit and Portaldot mainnet
- Real stablecoin savings
- Random or bid payout order
- Pilot circles in Lagos

Later

- Naira on- and off-ramp
- ink! reputation registry
- Cross-chain savings
- Lender integrations

Team

Chisom Caleb Ogueji

Founder and builder, Lagos

- Technical Lead and Developer at ShopSwift Technologies, a Nigerian merchant commerce platform
- Builds payments and AI-agent products, including SplitPay and Hunt
- Technical writer on blockchain since 2021 (Coinmonks, Mitosis University)
- B.Eng., Alex Ekwueme Federal University Ndufu-Alike

Help us take AjoChain to mainnet

We’re applying to the Portaldot ecosystem support program for:

- Contract review and mainnet migration support
- A building subsidy for hosting and a real stablecoin integration
- Community support to launch [10] pilot circles with Lagos traders

caleb@shopswiftpay.com github.com/blockchaincali/ajochain